

How can DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams be introduced into existing planning and reporting documents?

This tool uses the example of government planning and reporting documentation but it could be applied to any type of documentation. The current structure of government planning and reporting documentation is determined by a government's conventions and legislative requirements. Usually, there are things that must be included plans, sometimes set out in a specific text-and-table format. An initial step toward the comprehensive use of DoView Planning and strategy/outcomes diagrams is to incorporate DoViews within a government agency's existing planning and reporting documentation. First you can build a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram for an agency, policy, or initiative using the DoView Drawing Rules (B7). Such a DoView will have an overview page and a set of drill-down subpages for each major part of the agency or initiative's work.

For planning documents such as an annual plan, a longer-term plan, a statement of intent, or an annual report, you can insert an image of the DoView diagram's summary overview page at the start of the initial chapter that overviews all of the agency or initiative's work. Each subsequent chapter that is focused on a specific area can include the relevant DoView subpage at the start. Following the image of the subpage, information about that area can be included laid out in the existing required government reporting format (e.g. how you need to set out priorities, indicators, outputs, targets, risks, etc.).

Having a DoView subpage at the start of each section of planning or reporting documentation provides a quick, accessible visual overview for both technical and non-technical readers. Few people read right through government planning and reporting documents, and the inclusion of DoView subpages is an efficient way for most readers to get a quick feel for what an agency or initiative is doing.

Once DoViews are in use, politicians can mark them up to communicate their priorities to agencies they oversee. Currently, this is done by separate documents such as Ministerial Letters of Intent. As outlined in Tool I1 on the steps to introduce DoView Planning, the next step is to move from using PowerPoint, Google Slides or the DoView legacy app to using integrated planning apps and platforms that have incorporated DoView Planning features.